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Kevin P. Schönholzer

kevin.schoenholzer@usi.ch
orcID: 0000-0001-9892-5869

Education

Degree	Organisation	Duration
PhD, *Cumulative Thesis: "Educational Stratification in Comparative Perspective: The Role of Welfare Policies, Normative Beliefs, and Educational Expansion"* Grade: insigni cum laude Supervisors: Prof. Dr. Kaspar Burger, Prof. Dr. Michael Shanahan SNSF project "Understanding Social Gradients in Education"	Jacobs Center for Productive Youth Development, University of Zurich	10.2020 - 02.2025 (4 years 4 months)
International Max Planck Research School on the Life Course (LIFE), Graduate Training Program	Max Planck Institute for Human Development, Berlin	02.2023 - 02.2025 (2 years)
MA: Political Science and Economic History Thesis: "The Impact of Rising Income Inequality on Turnout in Switzerland 1995-2015" Supervisor: Stefanie Walter	University of Zurich, Department of Political Science	09.2017 - 09.2019 (2 years)
BA: Political Science	University of Toronto, Department of Political Science	08.2011 - 08.2015 (4 years)

Employment

Role	Organisation	Duration
Freelance Researcher, EUROGRADUATE 2026 methodology (survey codebook, national data-collection template, sampling and weighting notes, Labour Force Survey benchmark)	AIT Austrian Institute of Technology, Vienna, AT EU project "Development of a European Higher Education Sector Observatory" (EHESO)	10.2025 - present
Postdoctoral Researcher	Institute of Communication and Public Policy, Università della Svizzera italiana (USI), CH PI: Prof. Dr. Benedetto Lepori	05.2025 - present

Scientific Collaborator, Data and Infrastructure Team	Interfaculty Centre for Educational Research (ICER), University of Bern, CH Projects: SNSF Career Tracker Cohorts; assessment of basic competencies (ÜGK 2023), Canton of St. Gallen	10.2024 - 04.2025 (7 months)
Research Assistant	Eawag: Swiss Federal Institute of Aquatic Science and Technology, Zurich, CH EU project FANFAR (risk communication and perceptions)	10.2019 - 06.2020 (9 months)
Project Assistant	Centre for Higher Education and Science Studies (CHESS), University of Zurich, CH SNSF project "Organizational Models in Higher Education"	01.2018 - 12.2019 (2 years)
Administrative Employee	Enrollment Services, University of Toronto, CA	01.2016 - 06.2016 (6 months)

Teaching

Teaching contributions to BA/MA seminars of Prof. Dr. Kaspar Burger, University of Zurich:
Perspectives on the Life Course (Welfare States and the Life Course), 2022–2023
Inequalities of Education, 2021–2022
Perspectives on the Life Course, 2020–2021

Other Skills

Languages: English (native), German (native), Spanish (fluent), French (intermediate, B2), Italian (beginner, A2).

Software: R (advanced), R-Shiny (advanced), Python (advanced), Stata 18 (intermediate), LaTeX (intermediate), SQL (intermediate), Excel (advanced).

Publications

Peer-reviewed journal articles

Schoenholzer, K. (2026). Cumulative advantage in the early career: Within-person dynamics of the graduate income advantage in five countries. *Research in Social Stratification and Mobility*, 106, 101216. https://doi.org/10.1016/j.rssm.2026.101216

Schoenholzer, K., & Burger, K. (2024). Welfare state policy and educational inequality: A cross-national multicohort study. *European Sociological Review*, 40(6), 996–1012. https://doi.org/10.1093/esr/jcae003

Kuller, M., **Schoenholzer, K.**, & Lienert, J. (2021). Creating effective flood warnings: A framework from a critical review. *Journal of Hydrology*, 602, 126708. https://doi.org/10.1016/j.jhydrol.2021.126708

Reports

Wilhelmi, B., Lüthi, J., **Schönholzer, K.**, & Erzinger, A. (2025). SNSF Career Tracker Cohorts (CTC) Newsletter 2025/1. https://doi.org/10.48620/85598

Baron, F., Delavy, F., **Schönholzer, K.**, Jost, N. S., Erzinger, A. B., & Seiler, S. (2025). Kanton St.Gallen im Fokus: Die Überprüfung des Erreichens der Grundkompetenzen (ÜGK) 2023, Sprachen 11. Schuljahr. Interfaculty Centre for Educational Research (ICER), Universität Bern. https://doi.org/10.48620/88312

Grants, Scholarships

'Mobility grant in projects',
Swiss National Science Foundation (SNSF) Grant.
Visiting scholar, Ontario Institute for Studies in Education, University of Toronto.
March-August 2024, Main applicant. CHF 15'189.

University of Zurich (UZH) Graduate Campus Short Grant,
"Advancing Quantitative Perspectives in Educational Research",
Workshop and exchange between University of Cambridge and Jacobs Center for Productive Youth Development. Main applicant. CHF 4'500.

Working Papers

Under review

Schoenholzer, K. *Does Rising Cohort Achievement Narrow the Tertiary Earnings Gap? Evidence on Earnings Rank from 36 Countries.* Under review.

Schoenholzer, K., & Lepori, B. *Softening the binary divide: sorting and outcomes in the multi-pathway Swiss tertiary system.* Under review.

Schoenholzer, K. *Narrowed but Stable: Decomposing the SES Gradient in Tertiary Educational Expectations Across 33 OECD Countries, 2003-2022.* Under review.

In preparation

Schoenholzer, K. *When the Mother Holds the Degree: Parents' Education and Children's Skills in 79 Education Systems, 2003 to 2022.*

Schoenholzer, K. *Social Origin, Institutional Sorting, and Student Experience in Swiss Higher Education.*

Schoenholzer, K., & Lepori, B. *Are universities training too many PhD graduates? Skill allocation and job quality among doctorate holders in the Swiss labour market.*

Schoenholzer, K., & Burger, K. *Educational Expansion and Shifts in the Social Origins of Tertiary Graduates.*

Schoenholzer, K., & Burger, K. *Legitimizing Education-based Earnings Differences in an Era of Educational Expansion: Evidence from 28 Countries.*

Schoenholzer, K. *Social Origin, Gender and the Components of Adolescents' Environmental Action Competence: Evidence from PISA 2025.*

Peer Review

Reviewer for *European Sociological Review* and *Studies in Higher Education*.

Memberships

International Max Planck Research School on the Life Course (LIFE). Alumni.

International Sociological Association (ISA). ISA Research Committee on Social Stratification and Mobility (RC28).

Developmental Science Network Zurich. Junior Member. www.developmentalscience.uzh.ch

Contributions to Conferences

Schoenholzer, K., & Lepori, B. (2026). Doctoral labour market returns in Switzerland. *Talk at the online research seminar of the European Higher Education Sector Observatory (EHESO).* Virtual event.

Schoenholzer, K. (2026). Social Origin, Institutional Sorting, and Student Experience in Swiss Higher Education. *Talk at the 17th Conference of the European Sociological Association (ESA), Research Network 10, Sociology of Education.* Warsaw, Poland.

Schoenholzer, K. (2025). A Multilevel Analysis of Employment Outcomes of Graduates from Universities and Universities of Applied Sciences in Switzerland, 2011–2024. *Presentation at the annual conference of the Society for Research into Higher Education.* University of Nottingham, UK.

Schoenholzer, K., Burger, K., & Chmielewski, A. (2024). Educational Expansion and Changes in the Social Origin Composition of Tertiary Graduates – Comparing Cohorts Born 1948-1992 in Six Countries. *Roundtable at the annual meeting of the American Sociological Association (ASA).* Montreal, Canada.

Schoenholzer, K., Burger, K., & Chmielewski, A. (2024). Educational expansion and social mobility: evidence from seven longitudinal household panels. *Poster presentation at the International Max Planck Research School on the Life Course (LIFE) Academy*. University of Virginia, USA.

Schoenholzer, K., & Burger, K. (2023). Beliefs about the importance education should have for earnings across educational expansion. *Talk at the ECSR Annual Conference: European Societies in Times of Uncertainty*. Prague, Czech Republic.

Schoenholzer, K., & Burger, K. (2023). Beliefs about the importance education should have for earnings across educational expansion. *Talk at the International Max Planck Research School on the Life Course (LIFE) Academy*. University of Michigan, USA.

Schoenholzer, K., & Burger, K. (2022). Educational Inequality and Beliefs in Meritocracy. *Talk at the UZH/ ETH Thesis Workshop (internal)*. Ittingen, Switzerland.

Schoenholzer, K., & Burger, K. (2022). Welfare State Policy and Educational Inequality: A Cross-National Multi-cohort Study. *Poster presentation at the ISA RC28 Conference, Social Stratification and Mobility*. London School of Economics.

Schoenholzer, K., & Burger, K. (2021). Educational Inequality: Life-Course Outcomes of Welfare State Policy. *Talk at the GEBF, Early Career Researchers Conference*. Virtual event.

Schoenholzer, K., & Burger, K. (2021). Educational Inequality: Life-Course Outcomes of Welfare State Policy. *Talk at the GESIS Workshop on Causality in Social Sciences III, Heterogeneous Causal Effects*. Virtual event.

Schoenholzer, K., & Burger, K. (2021). Educational Inequality: A Life-Course Outcome of Poor Welfare State Policy. *Talk at the 4th International TREE Conference: "Life Course in the Making".* Bern, Switzerland.

Schoenholzer, K., & Burger, K. (2021). Educational Inequality: Life-Course Outcomes of Welfare State Policy. *Talk at the European Consortium for Sociological Research (ECSR).* Virtual event.

Schoenholzer, K., & Burger, K. (2021). Welfare State Policy and Educational Inequality: A Cross-National Multi-Cohort Study. *Talk at the UZH/ETH Thesis Workshop (internal).* Virtual event.